



Hubs, Sorting Centres & Volumes

A new joiner's deep-dive into the network that moves 245 million parcels a year

Companion to the New Joiner Business Handbook

How our terminals work · what they process · where they are

Sweden, Denmark, Norway, Finland — plus the international gateway

All figures approximate, from public 2024–2026 sources



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The Network in Numbers

PostNord — The Network

Before the map, the scale. These are the volumes that the terminal network exists to move — and the reason so much of the business is now built around parcels.

245M parcels delivered, 2024	840M letters & mail items, 2024	~800k parcels on a normal day	94% parcels delivered on time
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In 2024 PostNord delivered around **245 million parcels** and **840 million letters and other mail items** across the Nordics. Spread over a working year that is roughly **800,000 parcels on an ordinary day** — but volumes are far from flat. Parcels grew by double digits through 2025 (up about 12% over the first nine months), while letters keep falling. And the year has a sharp **peak**: during the pre-Christmas 'Black Week' rush, single-day parcel volumes in Sweden alone have topped **1.3 million**.

TWO CURVES MOVING IN OPPOSITE DIRECTIONS

Parcels are growing and letters are shrinking — so newer sites are built for **parcels**, while the older **mail** terminals are being consolidated. Understanding which kind of facility you are looking at explains most of what happens inside it.

The other half of the network is where customers collect and send: about **12,100 parcel pick-up and drop-off points** across the Nordics — service points in shops plus a fast-growing fleet of self-service lockers, rising to roughly 19,000 when every counter and locker is counted.

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Three Kinds of Facility

PostNord — The Network

'Terminal' is used loosely, but there are really three kinds of building in the network, each doing a different job:

Facility	What it handles	What happens there
Mail (letter) terminal	Letters, postcards, admin mail	High-speed letter sorting machines sequence mail down to the postal round. Volumes are large but falling; sites are being consolidated.
Parcel terminal / parcel centre	E-commerce parcels and small goods	Automated parcel sorters split a bulk flow into hundreds of destinations, ready for line-haul and last-mile. This is the growth area.
Logistics / TPL warehouse	Pallets, freight, and stored goods	Third-party logistics: storing a retailer's stock and picking, packing and shipping orders on their behalf.

A single location can combine roles — for example a parcel terminal beside a TPL warehouse, or a mail terminal that also stages parcels.

What actually happens inside a sorting centre

Whatever the label, an automated sorting centre runs the same basic sequence, day and night:



- 1 **Unload & intake** — trucks (and, at rail hubs, trains) are emptied; bulk items are tipped onto conveyors.
- 2 **Singulation** — machines (and increasingly AI robot arms) separate the pile into a single, evenly spaced stream.

- 3
- Read & register — cameras read the address label and measure each item, so the system knows where it must go.
- 4
- Sort — a high-speed cross-belt or tilt-tray sorter drops each item into the chute for its destination.
- 5
- Load line-haul — sorted items go into roll cages and containers, onto trucks and trains for the trunk leg.
- 6
- Destination & last mile — the receiving terminal sorts to delivery rounds; the item reaches a mailbox, door, locker or service point.

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Sweden's Main Terminals

PostNord — The Network

Sweden is the heart of the network. A handful of large mail terminals handle letters, while newer parcel terminals have been added to keep up with e-commerce. Here are the sites you will hear named most often.

Terminal	Where	Type	What makes it notable
Rosersberg	Stockholm (Sigtuna)	Mail — largest	Sweden's biggest terminal (~49,000 m²); handles roughly two million letters a day; rail-served; trialled an AI sorting robot.
Veddesta	Järfälla, Stockholm	Parcel centre	Energy-efficient cross-belt sorter; handles long parcels (up to ~1.2 m) with automatic singulators.
Hallsberg	Örebro County	Mail + rail hub	Central Sweden's rail junction, beside Scandinavia's largest freight yard; a natural cross-docking point.
Årsta	Central Stockholm	Mail / terminal	Long-standing Stockholm terminal serving the capital's flows.
Alvesta · Nässjö	Småland (south-central)	Mail	Regional letter sorting for southern Sweden.
Göteborg · Malmö	West coast · far south	Mail	Serve the second and third cities and the Öresund gateway to Denmark.
Sundsvall · Umeå	Northern Sweden	Mail	Anchor coverage across the long, sparsely populated north.
Örebro · Växjö · Helsingborg · Norrköping	Central & south	Parcel — newer	Added over recent years specifically to absorb growing e-commerce parcel volumes.
Vaggeryd (Södra Stigamo)	Jönköping County	Parcel — flagship (2028)	A SEK 1.1bn build opening in 2028: up to 25,000 parcels/hour and 1,000+ sorting directions — the highest capacity in Sweden.

Note: in late 2024 PostNord sold and leased back the Hallsberg and Nässjö mail-terminal properties — it still runs the operations, but no longer owns the buildings. Norrköping is also home to a 62,000 m² TPL warehouse.

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The Rest of the Nordics — and the Gateway

PostNord — The Network

Each country runs its own terminals, feeding a shared Nordic parcel network, with an international gateway handling cross-border e-commerce.

Hub	Country	What makes it notable
Hakkila (Vantaa)	Finland	PostNord's largest Finnish terminal (~15,000 m²); sorting machine handles almost 10,000 parcels an hour for the capital region.
Taulov Pakkecenter	Denmark (Jutland)	One of Denmark's oldest and largest parcel terminals; staffed around the clock except Saturdays.
Oslo area	Norway	A high-speed sorter processing up to ~8,000 parcels an hour; Norway's terminal network is being simplified to improve profitability.

Hub	Country	What makes it notable
Travemünde	Germany (International)	The continental gateway for Nordic e-commerce: a 137-metre sorter running up to ~9,000 items an hour.

Denmark is now a parcels-only operation — its letter business closed at the end of 2025. Norway and Finland are parcel-and-logistics markets served through these hubs and a dense network of pick-up points.

HOW IT FITS TOGETHER

A parcel posted in Malmö for delivery in Vantaa is collected locally, sorted at a Swedish parcel terminal, moved by line-haul (road, and rail where it helps) toward Finland, sorted again at Hakkila, and delivered from there. The terminals are the hand-off points that make that one-to-two-day Nordic journey possible.

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Automation, People and the Peak

PostNord — The Network

Terminals blend heavy automation with skilled people — the sorters do the repetitive routing, while people handle exceptions, oversized and fragile items, loading, and the judgement calls machines can't yet make.

The machines	The people
• Cross-belt & tilt-tray sorters route items to hundreds of destinations • Automatic singulators turn a bulk pile into a single, spaced stream • Cameras & scanners read addresses and measure every item • AI robot arms (trialled at Rosersberg) pick parcels ~twice as fast as by hand • Energy-efficient drives cut sorter power use markedly	• Terminal operators load, unload and keep the flow moving • Sorting & quality staff handle exceptions and mis-reads • Line-haul drivers run the trunk legs between terminals • Delivery staff — posties and drivers — do the last mile • Planners & team leads flex capacity around the daily peak

Built for the peak, not the average

The hardest days are before Christmas. During 'Black Week' the network shifts up a gear — extra shifts, extra line-haul, terminals running near sorter capacity. Designing for these peaks, not the quiet days, is why headline figures like Vaggeryd's 25,000 parcels an hour matter.

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Where the Network Is Heading

PostNord — The Network

Three threads run through all of the above — worth carrying into your first weeks:

- **Fewer, smarter parcel hubs** — big automated terminals (Vaggeryd leads) replace scattered older mail sites.
- **More self-service at the edge** — lockers and service points keep expanding for pick-up and returns.
- **Fossil-free by 2030** — solar-ready terminals, EV charging, and electric, renewable and rail line-haul.

THE ONE-LINE VERSION

PostNord is turning a legacy mail network into a modern Nordic parcel machine: fewer, high-capacity automated sorting centres, fed by trucks and trains, emptying into thousands of lockers and service points — a quarter of a billion parcels a year, and growing.